Agile Scrum: Components Explained

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Overview

Scrum is a lightweight framework for delivering complex work in short, fixed-length cycles called Sprints. It has 3 accountabilities, 3 artifacts and 4 events, all wrapped inside the Sprint itself.

- Accountabilities: Product Owner, Scrum Master, Developers
- Artifacts: Product Backlog, Sprint Backlog, Increment
- Events: Sprint Planning, Daily Scrum, Sprint Review, Sprint Retrospective

Accountabilities

The Scrum Team is one small team (usually 10 people or fewer) with one shared goal. It has no sub-teams or hierarchy.

Role	Responsibility	Key points
Product Owner	Maximizes the value of the product	One person, not a committee; owns and orders the Product Backlog; talks to stakeholders and decides what gets built and in what order
Scrum Master	Helps everyone understand and use Scrum well	Servant-leader and coach, not a project manager; removes blockers, facilitates events when needed, shields the team from interruptions
Developers	Create a usable Increment every Sprint	Designers, programmers, testers and others; self-managing; create the Sprint Backlog; accountable for quality and the Definition of Done

Stakeholders (users, customers, sponsors) sit outside the Scrum Team. They give feedback, mainly at the Sprint Review.

Artifacts

Each artifact carries one commitment that keeps the team focused and the work transparent.

Product Backlog

- A single, ordered list of everything the product might need: features, fixes, improvements, technical work.
- Never complete; it evolves as the product and market change.
- Ordered by the Product Owner, with the most valuable and clearest items at the top.
- Refined continuously: adding detail, estimates and order.
- Commitment: the Product Goal, the long-term objective the team works toward.

Sprint Backlog

- Contains the Sprint Goal, the selected Product Backlog items, and the plan to deliver them.
- Belongs to the Developers and is updated throughout the Sprint as they learn more.
- A live, visible picture of the work planned for the Sprint.
- Commitment: the Sprint Goal, one objective that gives the Sprint coherence and flexibility.

Increment

- A concrete, usable step toward the Product Goal; each Increment adds to all earlier ones.
- Must meet the Definition of Done, a shared checklist of what "finished" means (coded, tested, reviewed, documented, and so on).
- Several Increments can be created within one Sprint; work not meeting the Definition of Done is not part of the Increment.
- Commitment: the Definition of Done.

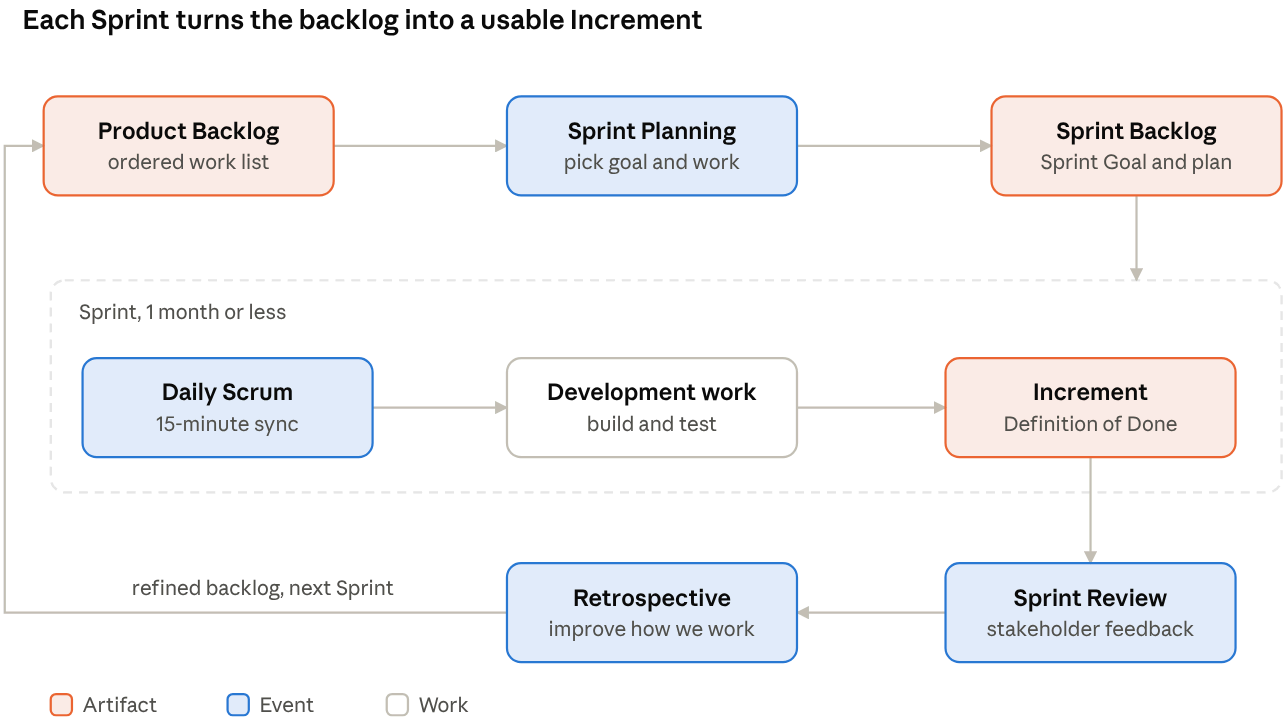
Events

Every event is timeboxed and gives a formal chance to inspect and adapt. Timeboxes below are maximums for a 1-month Sprint; shorter Sprints use shorter events.

Event	Who attends	Purpose	Timebox
Sprint	Scrum Team	Container for all other events; 1 month or less (usually 1 to 4 weeks); starts right after the previous one ends	1 month max
Sprint Planning	Whole Scrum Team	Answers why the Sprint is valuable, what can be done, and how the work will get done; produces the Sprint Goal and Sprint Backlog	8 hours
Daily Scrum	Developers	Inspects progress toward the Sprint Goal and adapts the plan for the next 24 hours; not a status report to management	15 minutes daily
Sprint Review	Scrum Team and stakeholders	Presents the Increment, gathers feedback, and adjusts the Product Backlog; a working session, not an approval demo	4 hours
Sprint Retrospective	Scrum Team	Inspects people, interactions, processes, tools and the Definition of Done; picks the most helpful improvements for the next Sprint	3 hours

The Sprint Goal stays fixed during the Sprint. Scope can be renegotiated with the Product Owner as more is learned, and only the Product Owner can cancel a Sprint.

How it all fits together



Scrum cycle · 3 artifacts, 4 events

The Product Owner keeps the backlog ordered, the team plans and builds an Increment inside the Sprint, stakeholders react at the Review, and the Retrospective feeds the next Sprint.

Pillars and values

Scrum rests on 3 pillars: transparency (the work and progress are visible to everyone), inspection (the team checks progress and results often), and adaptation (the team adjusts quickly when something drifts).

It is guided by 5 values: commitment, focus, openness, respect and courage.